

Martin Birkenbaum

SENIOR SOFTWARE ENGINEER

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Senior Software Engineer with 8+ years of experience designing, building, and deploying scalable distributed systems, focusing on data storage layers, high-throughput microservices, and performance optimization. Skilled in ensuring data consistency at scale and driving technical excellence across engineering teams.

SKILLS

- Languages:** Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, SQL, HTML/CSS
- Technologies & Frameworks:** Docker, Kubernetes, Git, GitOps, PostgreSQL, Distributed Systems, Data Modeling, Performance Tuning, Caching, Query Optimization, Consistency Models, Jinja2, WeasyPrint, pytest

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer at **Initech Corporation** 2021-03-01 – 2026-07-01

Led architecture and development of high-throughput microservices and GitOps-driven infrastructure pipelines.

- Architected and optimized Python-based distributed data processing systems, handling 10M+ daily events while ensuring data consistency and performance at scale.
- Standardized containerized deployments utilizing Docker, Kubernetes, and GitOps, foundational to building a scalable and resilient platform architecture.
- Mentored 6 junior/mid-level engineers, establishing robust code styling and rigorous testing standards to elevate team's technical bar and ensure system reliability.
- Developed custom internal toolchains that optimized development workflows and reduced CI pipeline execution times by 40%, demonstrating a focus on performance engineering and cost-aware design.

Software Engineer at **Hooli Inc.** 2018-06-01 – 2021-02-01

Backend engineer focused on building RESTful APIs, developer tooling, and automated deployment integrations.

- Developed robust, scalable REST APIs in Python/Django and TypeScript/Node.js, often involving complex data model interactions.
- Integrated third-party APIs and automated webhook processors, ensuring seamless data flow and interaction with external systems.
- Implemented a comprehensive suite of unit and integration tests, raising coverage from 60% to 92%, critical for ensuring correctness and data integrity.

PROJECTS

JobGitOps (Python, Nix, GitHub Actions) 2026-06-01 – 2026-07-01

A GitOps-driven job application and tracking system utilizing GitHub Issues, Projects, and Actions.

- Developed python-jobsby scraper integration and two-pass LLM fit triage
- Designed reproducible local environments via Nix and devenv

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science at **University of Washington**

2014-09-01 – 2018-06-01

GPA: 3.8